

The 1st Light

"Pilot Episode"

Written by

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1 EXT. COASTAL HIGHWAY -- AERIAL -- DAWN 1

A winding highway hugs the cliffs above a restless ocean. A single pair of headlights cuts through the pre-dawn fog.

CUT TO:

2 INT. SARAH'S CAR -- MOVING -- DAWN 2

SARAH CHEN (30s, sharp eyes, tired face) grips the steering wheel of a battered 1998 Honda Civic. A paper coffee cup sits in the cupholder, long cold. She wears a wrinkled blazer over a faded band t-shirt -- someone who left in a hurry.

Her phone buzzes. She glances at it -- cracked iPhone on the passenger seat displaying "DAD -- 3 Missed Calls." She silences it without answering.

SARAH
(to herself, barely
audible)
Not yet.

She reaches for the coffee cup, takes a sip, grimaces.

SMASH CUT TO:

3 EXT. PINE RIDGE MOTEL -- PARKING LOT -- MORNING 3

The Civic pulls into a near-empty lot. Only two other cars: a rusted pickup truck and a black SUV with tinted windows. The SUV feels conspicuous.

Sarah steps out, stretches. She pulls a leather duffel bag from the back seat and walks toward the office.

4 INT. PINE RIDGE MOTEL -- FRONT OFFICE -- MORNING 4

A bell jingles as Sarah enters. Behind the counter sits EARL (60s, leathery skin, reading glasses perched on his nose), flipping through a fishing magazine. Earl: flannel shirt, suspenders, reading glasses on a chain.

EARL
(not looking up)
Single or double.

SARAH
Single. Something in the back, if
you have it.

EARL
(finally looking up,
studying her)
Running from something or running
to something?

SARAH
(a beat, then a tired
smile)
Ask me when I check out.

★

-- Earl slides a brass room key (not a keycard -- old
school) across the counter. The tag reads Room 7.

CUT TO:

5 INT. MOTEL ROOM 7 -- MORNING

5

Sarah drops the duffel bag on the bed. She crosses to the
window, parts the curtains. Through the glass: the black SUV
hasn't moved.

SARAH
(under her breath)
Okay. So it's like that.

She unzips the duffel bag. Inside: clothes, a laptop, a
manila envelope thick with documents, and at the bottom,
wrapped in a cloth -- a compact handgun. on her hand hovering
over the gun. She chooses the manila envelope instead.

CUT TO:

5A INT. MOTEL ROOM 7 -- MOMENTS LATER

5A

Documents spread across the bed. We glimpse fragments:
financial spreadsheets, photographs of a corporate building,
a hand-drawn map with red circles. Sarah arranges them
methodically, building a case only she understands.

Her phone rings again. This time she answers.

SARAH
Dad, I can't talk right
now. I'm handling it.

FATHER (V.O.)
Handling it? Sarah, you
took the *files*. Do you
have any idea--

SARAH
I have every idea. That's the
problem.

She hangs up. Stares at the documents.

FADE TO BLACK.